APEX DIVISION

REACH YOUR PEAK WITH APEX DIVISION

APEX PHYSIQUE · 2026 EDITION

APEX DIVISION BODYBUILDING

APEX PHYSIQUE

THE COMPLETE BODYBUILDING BLUEPRINT

12	5	PPL+	ALL
WEEKS	DAYS / WEEK	SPLIT STYLE	LEVELS

A science-based hybrid program built to maximize muscle growth, improve symmetry, and develop a physique that turns heads — whether you're bulking, cutting, or recomping.

12

PROGRAM INDEX

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WHO THIS IS FOR

BUILT TO BUILD A REAL PHYSIQUE.

Apex Physique is a 12-week hybrid bodybuilding program built around one principle — **progressive stimulus over time**. Not just adding weight. Not just doing more sets. But intelligently cycling through volume, intensity, and technique to force your body to keep adapting long after most programs plateau.

Whether you've been training 6 months or 3 years, this program meets you where you are and pushes you further than you've been. The hybrid PPL and Upper/Lower structure hits every muscle group with the right frequency while giving you enough recovery to actually grow.

WHAT THIS PROGRAM DELIVERS

Increased muscle size across all major muscle groups. Improved muscle symmetry and proportion. A sustainable approach to progressive overload you can run beyond this 12 weeks. Exposure to advanced training techniques — drop sets, supersets, rest-pause — applied strategically, not randomly. A nutrition framework that supports growth without unnecessary fat gain.

WHAT YOU NEED

- **Full gym access** — barbells, dumbbells, cables, machines
- **Adjustable dumbbells or full dumbbell rack**
- **Cable machine** — essential for several accessory movements
- **Resistance bands** — optional but useful for warm-ups
- **A training log** — phone notes or a notebook. Non-negotiable.

HOW TO GET THE MOST FROM THIS

- **Log every session** — weight, sets, reps. Your log is your roadmap.
- **Film yourself** — form check quarterly at minimum
- **Prioritize sleep** — muscle is built outside the gym
- **Don't skip the small muscles** — rear delts, biceps, and calves matter
- **Trust the process** — weeks 8 to 12 are when the real changes show

12 WEEK OVERVIEW

PROGRAM STRUCTURE.

The program runs three distinct phases. Each phase builds on the last — you enter each block stronger, more conditioned, and better at the movements than when you started.

01

FOUNDATION PHASE

WEEKS 1-4

Moderate volume, moderate weight. Learning the movements, building the mind-muscle connection, establishing baselines. Rep ranges stay in the 10 to 15 zone. Techniques are straight sets only.

02

GROWTH PHASE

WEEKS 5-9

Volume peaks here. Sets increase by 1 per exercise. Rep ranges drop to 8 to 12 on compounds. Drop sets and supersets introduced strategically. This is the hardest block — it's supposed to be.

03

INTENSIFICATION PHASE

WEEKS 10-12

Volume pulls back slightly. Intensity ramps up. Rest-pause sets introduced on key movements. Heavier weights, lower rep ranges (6 to 10). The goal is to lock in the strength gained and finish at your peak.

WEEKLY LAYOUT

DAY	SESSION TYPE	PRIMARY FOCUS
MONDAY	Push — Heavy	Chest, Shoulders, Triceps
TUESDAY	Pull — Heavy	Back, Biceps, Rear Delts
WEDNESDAY	Legs — Primary	Quads, Hamstrings, Glutes, Calves
THURSDAY	Upper — Hypertrophy	Full Upper Body, Higher Volume
FRIDAY	Lower — Hypertrophy	Full Lower Body, Higher Volume
SATURDAY	Active Recovery	Walk, Stretch, Mobility Work
SUNDAY	Full Rest	—

THE GROWTH ENGINE

HOW YOU PROGRESS.

Progressive overload is the single most important factor in muscle growth. Your body only grows when it's forced to adapt to a stimulus it hasn't handled before. This program cycles through three overload methods to keep adaptation constant and plateaus rare.

METHOD 1 — WEIGHT PROGRESSION

WHEN THE REPS ARE MAXED — ADD WEIGHT

If your target range is 10 to 12 reps and you hit 12 clean reps on all sets — add 5 lbs next session. Simple. Don't add weight until you own the top of the rep range.

METHOD 2 — REP RANGE PROGRESSION

FILL THE RANGE BEFORE ADDING LOAD

Start at the bottom of the range (e.g. 8 reps). Each week add 1 to 2 reps until you reach the top (12 reps). Then add weight and reset to 8. This is double progression — it works.

METHOD 3 — VOLUME PROGRESSION

Weeks 1 to 4 you perform 3 working sets per exercise. Weeks 5 to 9 you add a fourth set to every compound movement. This increase in total weekly volume is one of the most reliable hypertrophy drivers in the research. Your muscles are doing more total work — they have no choice but to grow.

THE GOLDEN RULE OF THIS PROGRAM

Every session should have at least one thing that was better than last session — more weight, more reps, or better form. If nothing improved, ask yourself why. Nutrition? Sleep? Effort? Fix the variable, don't accept stagnation.

FULL TRAINING SPLIT

THE FULL PROGRAM.

Sets and rep ranges shown are for the Foundation Phase (Weeks 1–4). Growth Phase adds one set to all compound movements. Intensification Phase reduces reps by 2 and increases load. Technique markers indicate where advanced techniques are introduced in later phases.

MON PUSH — HEAVY

CHEST, SHOULDERS, TRICEPS · COMPOUND FOCUS · STRENGTH-HYPERTROPHY

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	REST	TECHNIQUE	NOTES
Flat Barbell Bench Press *Primary chest compound — competition grip*	4×6–8	3 min	—	Full range, controlled descent, drive through chest
Overhead Press (Barbell or DB) *Primary shoulder compound*	3×8–10	2–3 min	—	Full lockout at top, don't flare elbows
Incline Dumbbell Press *Upper chest emphasis*	3×10–12	90 sec	Drop Set Wk5+	30–45 degree incline, deep stretch
Cable Lateral Raises *Side delt isolation — width builder*	3×15–20	60 sec	Superset Wk5+	Slight forward lean, lead with elbow
Chest Dips *Lower chest and tricep mass builder*	3×10–12	90 sec	—	Lean forward for chest emphasis
Tricep Pushdowns *Cable — rope or straight bar*	3×12–15	60 sec	Drop Set Wk7+	Full extension, squeeze at bottom
Overhead Tricep Extension *Long head isolation — cable or dumbbell*	3×12–15	60 sec	—	Keep elbows close, full stretch at top

TUE PULL — HEAVY

BACK, BICEPS, REAR DELTS · THICKNESS AND WIDTH · STRENGTH-HYPERTROPHY

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	REST	TECHNIQUE	NOTES
Weighted Pull-Ups or Lat Pulldown *Primary lat width builder*	4×6–8	3 min	—	Full stretch at top, pull elbows to ribs
Barbell Bent Over Row *Primary back thickness compound*	4×8–10	2–3 min	—	Hinge at hip, pull to lower chest, control return
Seated Cable Row *Mid back and rhomboid builder*	3×10–12	90 sec	Rest-Pause Wk10+	Chest up, full stretch, squeeze at end
Single Arm Dumbbell Row *Unilateral back — fixes imbalances*	3×10–12 each	90 sec	—	Full range, don't rotate at the hip
Rear Delt Fly (Cable or Dumbbell) *Posterior delt — critical for shoulder health and aesthetics*	3×15–20	60 sec	Superset Wk5+	Bent over, lead with elbows, no momentum
Barbell or Dumbbell Curl *Primary bicep compound*	3×10–12	60 sec	Drop Set Wk7+	Full supination at top, controlled descent
Hammer Curl *Brachialis and forearm builder*	3×12–15	60 sec	—	Neutral grip throughout, no swinging

WED LEGS — PRIMARY

QUADS, HAMSTRINGS, GLUTES, CALVES · FULL LOWER BODY · HIGH VOLUME

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	REST	TECHNIQUE	NOTES
Barbell Back Squat *Primary quad and glute compound*	4×8–10	3 min	—	Depth at or below parallel, knees track toes
Romanian Deadlift *Primary hamstring and glute hinge*	3×10–12	2–3 min	—	Full stretch at bottom, hips drive forward at top
Leg Press *Quad volume — moderate foot placement*	3×12–15	90 sec	Drop Set Wk5+	Full range, don't lock out knees
Walking Lunges *Unilateral quad and glute*	3×12 each	90 sec	—	Long stride, upright torso, knee to floor

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	REST	TECHNIQUE	NOTES
Lying or Seated Leg Curl *Hamstring isolation*	3×12–15	60 sec	Rest-Pause Wk10+	Full range, squeeze at top
Standing Calf Raise *Gastrocnemius builder*	4×15–20	60 sec	—	Full stretch at bottom, pause at top

THU UPPER — HYPERTROPHY

FULL UPPER BODY · HIGHER REP RANGES · VOLUME FOCUSED

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	REST	TECHNIQUE	NOTES
Incline Barbell or Smith Machine Press *Upper chest compound — hypertrophy focus*	3×10–12	2 min	—	Controlled tempo — 3 seconds down, explode up
Cable Chest Fly *Chest isolation — full stretch and squeeze*	3×12–15	60 sec	Superset with row Wk5+	Arms slightly bent, meet hands at center
Machine or Cable Row *Back volume — mid and upper back*	3×12–15	60 sec	Superset with fly Wk5+	Squeeze scapula at end range
Dumbbell Lateral Raises *Side delt — shoulder width*	4×15–20	60 sec	Drop Set Wk5+	Slight forward lean, pinky high
Face Pulls *Rear delt and rotator cuff health*	3×15–20	60 sec	—	Pull to face level, external rotation at end
Cable Curl *Constant tension bicep curl*	3×12–15	60 sec	—	Low pulley, full curl, squeeze at top
Skull Crushers *Tricep long head — EZ bar or dumbbell*	3×10–12	60 sec	Rest-Pause Wk10+	Lower to forehead, full extension

FRI LOWER — HYPERTROPHY

FULL LOWER BODY · VOLUME AND ISOLATION FOCUS · POSTERIOR CHAIN EMPHASIS

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	REST	TECHNIQUE	NOTES
Hack Squat or Leg Press *Quad hypertrophy — controlled and full range*	4×10–12	2 min	—	Feet shoulder width, full depth
Barbell Hip Thrust *Primary glute builder*	4×10–12	2 min	—	Full hip extension at top, pause 1 second
Leg Extension *Quad isolation — terminal knee extension*	3×15–20	60 sec	Drop Set Wk7+	Full extension, squeeze at top
Nordic Curl or Leg Curl *Hamstring strength and length*	3×10–12	90 sec	—	Full range, avoid cheating with hips
Bulgarian Split Squat *Unilateral glute and quad — brutal but effective*	3×10–12 each	90 sec	—	Rear foot elevated, front foot forward enough
Seated Calf Raise *Soleus — inner calf builder*	4×15–20	60 sec	—	Full stretch, pause at bottom
Ab Circuit *Cable crunch, leg raise, plank — rotate weekly*	3×15–20	60 sec	—	Controlled contraction, no momentum

ADVANCED METHODS

TRAINING TECHNIQUES.

These techniques are tools — not party tricks. Each one is applied strategically at specific points in the program for maximum effect. Do not use them from week one. They are introduced progressively as your body adapts.

DROP SETS — INTRODUCED WEEK 5

Complete your working set, then immediately reduce the weight by 20 to 30% and continue for additional reps without rest. One drop set per exercise maximum. Best applied to isolation movements — lateral raises, curls, pushdowns, leg extensions. Never on squats or deadlifts.

SUPERSETS — INTRODUCED WEEK 5

Two exercises performed back to back with minimal rest between them. Used in this program as antagonist supersets — push with pull, chest with back, bicep with tricep. Saves time, increases density, and keeps intensity high. Rest 90 seconds after both exercises are complete.

REST-PAUSE SETS — INTRODUCED WEEK 10

Perform your set to within 1 to 2 reps of failure. Rack the weight. Rest 15 seconds. Squeeze out 3 to 5 more reps. Rest 15 seconds again. Squeeze out 2 to 3 more. This extends a single set far past normal failure — one of the most potent hypertrophy techniques available. Use sparingly — one or two movements per session maximum.

WHEN NOT TO USE TECHNIQUES

Skip advanced techniques on your main compound lifts. Skip them on deload weeks. Skip them if you're running on poor sleep or nutrition. And never use them as an excuse to use lighter weight — the base load should still be challenging before the technique is applied.

FUELING GROWTH

NUTRITION FOR BODYBUILDING.

Training is the stimulus. Nutrition is the material. You cannot build muscle in a consistent caloric deficit — your body needs surplus energy to construct new tissue. Here's how to eat for growth without piling on unnecessary fat.

CALCULATE YOUR STARTING POINT

Bodyweight in lbs × 15 to 17 = estimated maintenance calories. Add 200 to 300 calories to that number for a lean bulk. This keeps fat gain minimal while still supporting muscle growth. If you're not gaining at least 0.5 lbs per week — eat more. If you're gaining more than 1 lb per week — pull back slightly.

1G	45%	25%
PER LB BODYWEIGHT MINIMUM	OF TOTAL DAILY CALORIES	OF TOTAL DAILY CALORIES
PROTEIN	**CARBOHYDRATES**	**FATS**

TRAINING DAY NUTRITION

- **Pre-workout (1–2 hrs before):** Carb and protein focused. Rice, oats, pasta with chicken or eggs.
- **Intra-workout:** Water minimum. Carb drink optional for sessions over 75 minutes.
- **Post-workout (within 1 hr):** Fast protein + carbs. Shake with banana, rice and meat, anything you can get in quickly.
- **Before bed:** Casein or cottage cheese — slow digesting protein to feed overnight recovery.

BEST FOOD SOURCES

- **Protein:** Chicken, steak, eggs, Greek yogurt, fish, whey protein
- **Carbs:** White rice, oats, sweet potato, fruit, bread, pasta
- **Fats:** Olive oil, avocado, whole eggs, nuts, fatty fish
- **Hydration:** Minimum 1 gallon of water daily — more on training days

TRACK EVERYTHING

YOUR PROGRESS TRACKER.

Log your top set weight for key movements each week. Watching this fill up is proof the work is paying off.

MOVEMENT	WK1	WK2	WK3	WK4	WK5	WK6	WK7	WK8	WK9	WK10	WK11	WK12
BENCH PRESS	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
OHP	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
PULL-UPS	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
BARBELL ROW	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
BACK SQUAT	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
HIP THRUST	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
BODYWEIGHT	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—

ALSO TRACK MONTHLY

Take a front, back, and side photo on the same day each month under the same lighting. Muscle growth is slow — weekly photos show nothing. Monthly photos show everything. Keep them all and compare month 1 to month 3. The difference will surprise you.

APEX DIVISION

THE PHYSIQUE YOU WANT IS EARNED.

There's no shortcut to a great physique. No secret program, no magic supplement, no hack. Just consistent training, smart nutrition, and enough discipline to show up when you don't feel like it.

Twelve weeks from now your body will reflect exactly what you put into this. Make it count.

And when you finish — come back. Your Apex Division coaches are here to take you further.

— APEX DIVISION COACHING